

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk The move fails when you soften the issue so far that impact, accountability, or s

THE MOVE

Assume a reasonable reason + name the observable issue + invite correction or a next step. -> I'm assuming [reasonable reason / good intent / constraint], and I noticed [observable issue]. Can we [check / decide / repair / agree a next step]? -...

START HERE

Notice the ambiguity, choose the most plausible benign reading, say it in one light sentence, ask for the missing context, then respond to the facts: "I'm assuming there's a reasonable reason. Can you walk me through it?"

SAY THIS

Quick openers	<i>"I'm assuming there's a reasonable reason. Can you walk me through it?"</i>
Charitable readings	<i>"I'm guessing you were trying to keep this simple."</i>
Work and decisions	<i>"I'm assuming this was a bandwidth issue rather than a priority call. Where does it stand now?"</i>
Assumption plus ask	<i>"I'm assuming this got crowded out rather than ignored. Can we reset the deadline now?"</i>
Digital / text	<i>"Tone's hard over text, so I'm assuming this is concise rather than sharp. Fair?"</i>
When it lands wrong	<i>"I may have softened that too much. The issue is still real."</i>

AVOID

- Repeated breaches after you have already asked directly.
- Abusive, discriminatory, coercive, or unsafe behaviour.
- When a harmed person needs you to name the impact plainly first.

REMEMBER

Assume a reasonable reason, then ask for the real one.